tens of billions of dollars and kept the deficit from growing even larger than it did. Based on these recommendations and those of other advisory panels, for example, we eliminated seventy-five federal printing offices that we didn't need (and eliminated about half the government's publications, including such best sellers as *How to Buy Eggs)*. Just by installing improved accounting and cash-flow management systems in a few agencies to handle the federal government's $2-trillion-a-year cash flow, we earned taxpayers billions of dollars a year in additional interest revenues on the government's money. The number of different computer payroll systems used in government was reduced to fewer than 50 from 132; the number of accounting systems was reduced from 380 to fewer than 250. While the size of the federal bureaucracy was reduced, the application of modern, streamlining administrative procedures brought down the time it took to obtain a Social Security card from forty-nine days to ten; the time to get a passport from forty-three days to ten; and the time to get an export license from seventy-five days to seventeen. The proportion of federal contracts awarded competitively was increased from less than forty percent to fifty-eight percent. The volume of new regulations, listed each day in the *Federal Register*, was reduced by forty-three percent, or an average of 149 pages a day. Overall, the average number of regulations issued by the government during our administration marked a decline of forty-one percent compared with the number issued during the previous administration.

We tried to implement all the Grace Commission's recommendations and those of other advisory groups I appointed with a challenge to give Americans a better payoff for their tax dollars—but many of the proposals needed legislative approval, and various groups that hold sway over Congress kept us from getting all we wanted.